



VIT

Vellore Institute of Technology

(Deemed to be University under section 3 of UGC Act, 1956)

CHENNAI

Continuous Assessment Test - 1

August 2026

Programme	: M.Tech.	Semester	: Fall Semester 2026-27	
Course Title	: Technical Report Writing	Code	: MAENG501	
		Class Nbr.	: CH2026270103604	
Faculty	: Dr. Samik Malla	Slot	: TF1	
Time	: 1 Hr 30 Minutes	Max. Marks	: 50	

Answer ALL the Questions

(5 x 10 = 50 Marks)

Questions 1 to 4 require a short structured answer of about 150 words each. Budget fifteen minutes per question.

Q.No.	Sub. Sec.	Question Description	Marks	Module No.	Level E/M/D	Hot? Y/N	CO	BT
1.		Explain the roles of purpose, audience and tone in technical writing, and say why a writer must settle all three before drafting begins. Support your answer with examples.	[10]	1	E	N	1	BT4
2.		Describe the four stages of the writing process — plan, draft, revise and edit — and explain what each stage contributes to a technical report. Then discuss the claim that writing produces thought rather than merely records it.	[10]	1	E	N	1	BT2
3		Distinguish technical writing from creative writing, taking ambiguity as your point of contrast: why is ambiguity a resource in the one and a defect in the other? Explain why clarity is central to technical writing, and address the idea that clarity is not the same thing as simplicity.	[10]	1	E	N	1	BT3
4.		(a) Explain the principle of concord, and describe the difficulties it presents with (i) collective nouns and with (ii) either / or and (iii) neither / nor constructions. Give one example sentence of your own for each of the three. [5] (b) Explain the use of tenses in research writing. [5]	[5 + 5 = 10]	2	E	N	3	BT4
5.		Correct the error in each of the following sentences. Rewrite each sentence correctly. [10 × 1 = 10] (i) Each of the wards were surveyed in November. (ii) The datas from the questionnaire were incomplete. (iii) The survey examined 300 residents and shows that only 41% acted on the alert. (iv) One of the councillors were absent from the review meeting. (v) The number of complaints have risen since the alert was issued. (vi) Earlier studies has reported the same pattern. (vii) Neither the engineers nor the vendor were informed of the fault. (viii) After analysing the responses, the report was submitted to the Commissioner. (ix) Due to the fact that the sample was small, the findings varied.	[10 × 1 = 10]	2	E	N	3	BT3

		(x) The committee are still reviewing the recommendations.							
		Total Marks	1501						